



**EDU TERIA**

**72<sup>nd</sup> BPSC**

*Prelims Online Batch*

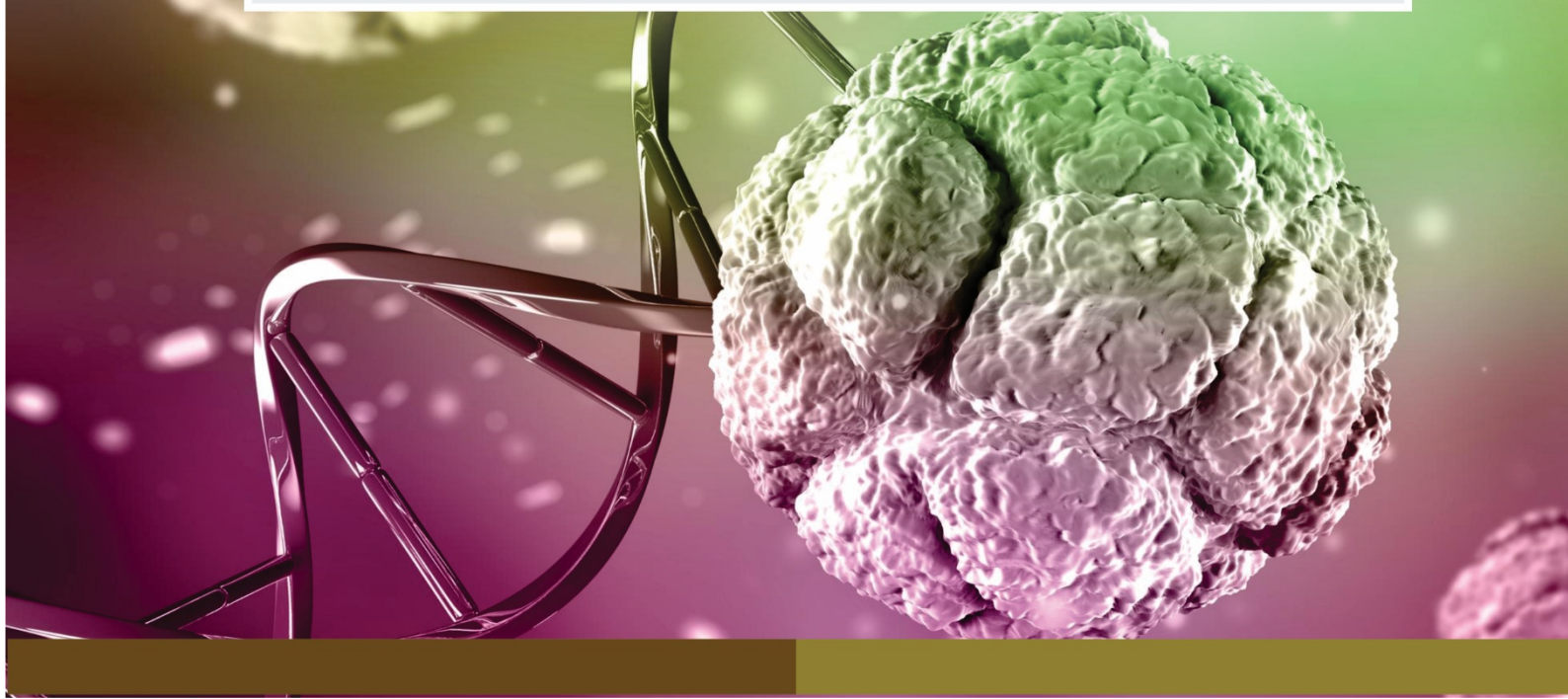
**BIOLOGY**

Topic wise  
**Notes**

**LECTURE**

**18**

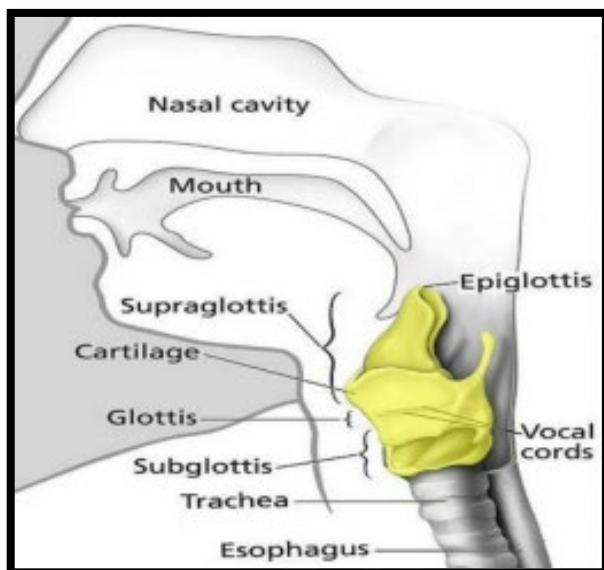
**Respiratory System- 01**





## Nasopharyngeal Cavity

The nasopharyngeal cavity (nasopharynx) is the uppermost part of the throat, located behind the nose and above the soft palate.

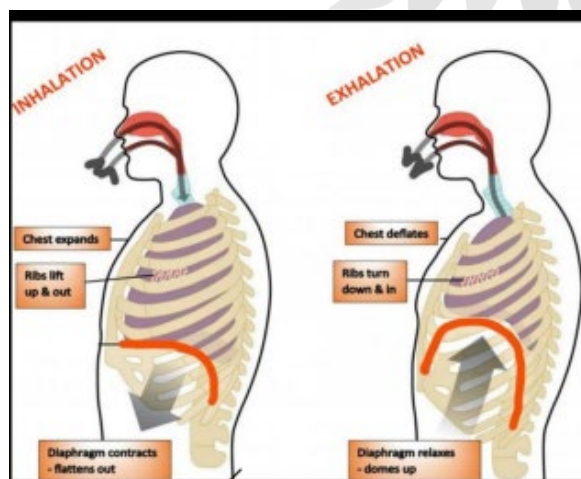


### Location

Lies posterior to the nose Extends from the base of the skull to the soft palate Above the oropharynx.

## Breathing Process

Breathing (respiration) is the two-phase process of inhaling oxygen and exhaling carbon dioxide, driven by the diaphragm and rib muscles.



### 1. Inspiration (Inhalation)

Air enters the lungs

Oxygen-rich air is taken in

**Mechanism** : Diaphragm contracts and flattens Intercostal muscles contract → ribs move upward & outward Thoracic cavity volume increases Lung pressure decreases

(below atmospheric pressure) Air rushes into lungs.

**Result:** Lungs fill with oxygen-rich air

### 2. Expiration (Exhalation)

- Air leaves the lungs
- Carbon dioxide-rich air is expelled

### Mechanism:

- Diaphragm relaxes (dome-shaped)
- Intercostal muscles relax → ribs move downward & inward.
- Thoracic cavity volume decreases Lung pressure increases.
- Air is forced out of lungs
- **Result:** Carbon dioxide is removed from the body

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